

Same question, same day: what does an AI assistant find with and without LC Connect?

We asked Claude and ChatGPT to list companies in Poland and the Czech Republic that use pulsed laser diodes. Once with LC Connect switched off, once with it switched on.

16 Polish PLD prospects from our lead base, in one question Claude with LC Connect listed every Polish lead linked to pulsed laser diodes, as a table, in about 30 seconds. ChatGPT with LC Connect named 16 Polish companies too, all from our base.	0 companies named with LC Connect that are not in our base Across all 4 "with LC Connect" answers (Claude and ChatGPT, Poland and Czech Republic), every company named is a record you can open.	12 → 8 Polish companies Claude named from memory → how many are in our base ChatGPT, Poland: 6 → 4. Czech Republic: Claude 11 → 4, ChatGPT 5 → 0. Without LC Connect, every company outside our base has to be checked by hand.
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What this means

- 01

Without LC Connect, the assistant answers from memory or the open web: the famous defence names, plausible guesses, and firms it says itself it cannot confirm.
- 02

With LC Connect, it answers from our lead base. Every company it names is one of our leads, with product fit, status and owner.
- 03

One question gives the full Polish PLD prospect list (16). By hand, that means filtering a spreadsheet.
- 04

The assistant says what the base does not know. Claude marked city as "unverified" because our base has none stored; ChatGPT wrote "not recorded" instead of guessing.
- 05

Answers are only as good as the base: Germany is not in it yet, and 219 of 396 leads still have no country. That is the next research step.

sources: raw/claude-with-Q1-v4.md, raw/chatgpt-with-Q1-v2.md (16) · raw/claude-with-Q1-v4.md, raw/claude-with-Q2-v5.md, raw/chatgpt-with-Q1-v2.md, raw/chatgpt-with-Q2-v2.md (0) · raw/claude-without-Q1.md, raw/chatgpt-without-Q1/Q2.md, raw/claude-without-Q2.md vs LC base lists in LC-Connect-Comparison.md §3.2/§4.2 (12 → 8 etc.)

How we tested

The two questions (word for word)

Poland. "List companies in Poland that use pulsed laser diodes (PLD, 905 nm or 1550 nm) in their products, for example laser rangefinders, LiDAR or proximity fuzes. For each company give: name, city, the product or application, and how confident you are."

Czech Republic. The same question, with "Poland" replaced by "the Czech Republic".

When

29 September 2026, CEST (times per run in the table below). Claude's Poland run with LC Connect came after a same-day fix to how results reach Claude. ChatGPT's runs with LC Connect came after the account owner replaced ChatGPT custom instructions that had pointed it at a different connector.

With and without

- **Without LC Connect:** a new chat with the LC Connect connection switched off. The assistant uses its own knowledge, and ChatGPT also searched the web on its own.
- **With LC Connect:** a new chat with the connection switched on, so the assistant can look up our lead base.

Why the ChatGPT "without" answers are from the afternoon. Evening reruns with no app selected are not a fair "without": LC Connect was installed by then, and ChatGPT used it on its own (both answers open "I checked LC Connect first"). We use the afternoon runs, made before the app existed in the account.

Tip for your own test: to see a true "without" in ChatGPT, use a temporary chat or disconnect the app. An installed app may be used automatically, even when it is not selected.

Assistants

ASSISTANT	WITHOUT LC CONNECT	WITH LC CONNECT
Claude claude.ai, web search off	Poland and Czech Republic (15:18–15:21)	Poland: after the fix (22:18). Czech Republic: after the fix, re-verified (23:02).
ChatGPT Free plan, Thinking mode	Poland and Czech Republic (15:28–15:31), before the app was installed	Poland and Czech Republic (22:43–22:46)
Microsoft Copilot Laser Components' own platform	<i>To be run by Laser Components with the same question</i>	<i>To be run by Laser Components with the same question</i>

Honest limitations

- **Coverage.** The base holds leads in 34 countries, but **not yet Germany** (a search for Germany returns 0 leads).
- **Missing countries.** 219 of the 396 leads still have no country, so a country question can miss some real prospects.
- **What "linked to PLD" means.** It means "a prospect for that product", found by our researchers. It does not confirm that the company buys PLDs today.

sources: raw/*.md (prompt, time, settings per run) · raw/chatgpt-without-Q1-v2.md, raw/chatgpt-without-Q2-v2.md (evening "without" reruns that called LC Connect) · raw/A_lc_leads_by_country.json (34 countries) · raw/A_lc_search_leads_Germany.json (0) · LC-Connect-Comparison.md §2 (396 leads, 219 without country)

Poland: which companies each assistant named

● in our lead base ○ not in our lead base Last column: our base, Polish leads linked to pulsed laser diodes (16 of 25 Polish leads)

CLAUDE WITHOUT LC CONNECT	CLAUDE WITH LC CONNECT	CHATGPT WITHOUT LC CONNECT	CHATGPT WITH LC CONNECT	OUR LEAD BASE PLD-LINKED
● PCO S.A. ● CRW Telesystem-Mesko ● Mesko S.A. ○ Dezamet S.A. ● WB Group (WB Electronics) ● PIT-RADWAR ● Huta Stalowa Wola ○ Advanced Protection Systems ○ Delta Optical ○ Łukasiewicz – Inst. of Microelectronics and Photonics ● WAT, Institute of Optoelectronics ● VIGO Photonics 12 named 8 in base · 4 PLD-linked	● Instytut Optoelektroniki WAT ● WB Electronics (WB Group) ● Etronika ● Mesko S.A. ● WITU ● Semicon Sp. z o.o. ● Autocomp Management ● Huta Stalowa Wola (HSW) ● ZMT Tarnów ● CTL Laserinstruments ● OEM Tech ● Perspectiva Solutions ● Solaris Optics S.A. ● FIBRAIN ● Fluence Technology ● TopGaN 16 named 16 in base · 16 PLD-linked	● CRW Telesystem-Mesko ○ TOYA S.A. / YATO ○ AiQ robotics P.S.A. ● MESKO S.A. ● PCO S.A. ● WB Electronics / WB Group 6 named 4 in base · 2 PLD-linked	● Semicon Sp. z o.o. ● WITU ● Perspectiva Solutions ● CTL Laserinstruments ● OEM Tech ● Zakłady Mechaniczne Tarnów (ZMT) ● Autocomp Management ● Mesko S.A. ● Instytut Optoelektroniki WAT ● Huta Stalowa Wola (HSW) ● WB Electronics / WB Group ● Etronika ● PIT-RADWAR ● PCO S.A. ● CRW Telesystem-Mesko ● LiDAR3D 16 named 16 in base · 12 PLD-linked	● Autocomp Management ● CTL Laserinstruments ● Etronika ● FIBRAIN ● Fluence Technology ● Huta Stalowa Wola (HSW) ● Instytut Optoelektroniki WAT ● Mesko S.A. ● OEM Tech ● Perspectiva Solutions ● Semicon ● Solaris Optics ● TopGaN ● WB Electronics (WB Group) ● WITU ● ZMT Tarnów 16 PLD-linked leads

Without LC Connect, both assistants reach for the well-known defence names; about two in three are in our base, and the rest has to be checked by hand. With LC Connect, Claude returned exactly the 16 Polish PLD prospects in one question. ChatGPT named 16 as well, all of them leads in our base: 12 PLD prospects and 4 LiDAR prospects. It answered in 9 seconds, in Polish.

PCO, CRW Telesystem-Mesko, PIT-RADWAR, VIGO Photonics and LiDAR3D are in the base as LiDAR prospects, not PLD prospects. That is why they carry a dot but are not in the last column.

sources: raw/claude-without-Q1.md · raw/claude-with-Q1-v4.md · raw/chatgpt-without-Q1.md · raw/chatgpt-with-Q1-v2.md · LC base: LC-Connect-Comparison.md §3.2 (live pull 15:39 CEST), raw/A_lc_groundtruth_Poland.tsv

Czech Republic: which companies each assistant named

● in our lead base ○ not in our lead base Last column: our base, Czech leads linked to pulsed laser diodes (14 of 29 Czech leads)

CLAUDE WITHOUT LC CONNECT	CLAUDE WITH LC CONNECT	CHATGPT WITHOUT LC CONNECT	CHATGPT WITH LC CONNECT	OUR LEAD BASE PLD-LINKED
● Meopta – optika ● Optokon ○ Safibra ○ Valeo (R&D centre, Prague) ○ Camea ○ Prototypa-ZM ○ MESIT (defence division) ○ Varroc Lighting Systems ● Primoco UAV ● Workswell ○ VTÚ (Military Technical Institute) 11 named 4 in base · 1 PLD-linked	● Saab Czech Rep. (Training Systems) ● VR Group a.s. ● Metrodat s.r.o. ● LPP Holding a.s. ● Elya Solutions s.r.o. ● Primoco UAV SE ● Excalibur Army ● Tatra Defence Vehicle ● Aero Vodochody ● Glomex Military Supplies ● Ray Service a.s. ● Lightigo s.r.o. ● Narran s.r.o. ● LASER-TECH ● IPG Photonics (Czech Rep.) ● Meopta – optika ● EVPU Defence ● RETIA a.s. ● Pramacom-HT ● OPTOKON a.s. ● Argotech a.s. ● CRYTUR ● SQS Vláknová optika ● Frentech Aerospace 24 named 24 in base · 15 PLD-linked	○ ARCHER-LPP s.r.o. ○ SEFOR Solutions s.r.o. ○ OptiDynerx / Night Pearl ○ Abacus Electric / EVOLVEO ○ FOMEI s.r.o. 5 named 0 in base · 0 PLD-linked	● Ray Service a.s. ● Lightigo s.r.o. ● LASER-TECH spol. s r.o. ● Saab Czech Rep. (Training Systems) ● IPG Photonics (Czech Rep.) ● Aero Vodochody Aerospace ● Tatra Defence Vehicle ● Excalibur Army ● Narran s.r.o. ● Glomex Military Supplies ● LPP Holding a.s. ● Elya Solutions ● Primoco UAV SE ● VR Group a.s. 14 named 14 in base · 14 PLD-linked	● Aero Vodochody Aerospace ● Elya Solutions ● Excalibur Army ● Glomex Military Supplies ● IPG Photonics (Czech Rep.) ● LASER-TECH ● Lightigo ● LPP Holding ● Narran ● Primoco UAV ● Ray Service ● Saab Czech Rep. (Training) ● Tatra Defence Vehicle ● VR Group 14 PLD-linked leads

From memory or the web, the assistants named mostly different Czech firms: 4 of Claude's 11 and none of ChatGPT's 5 are in our base. Some of those, such as ARCHER-LPP or SEFOR Solutions, may be worth a look by the research team. With LC Connect, ChatGPT named exactly the 14 Czech PLD prospects in our base, and wrote "not recorded" for city and confidence instead of guessing. Claude's first post-fix attempt stalled and never answered; a same-night repeat, after a one-call-rule fix, returned 24 Czech leads in two tables (15 linked to 905 nm pulsed laser diodes, 9 to LiDAR) with a confidence judgement on every row, in about 90 seconds.

sources: raw/claude-without-Q2.md · raw/claude-with-Q2-v5.md (post-fix, 23:02 CEST; an earlier post-fix attempt, raw/claude-with-Q2-v4.md, did not complete) · raw/chatgpt-without-Q2.md · raw/chatgpt-with-Q2-v2.md · LC base: LC-Connect-Comparison.md §4.2 (live pull 15:39 CEST), raw/A_lc_groundtruth_Czech.tsv

What the assistant answered

With LC Connect: Claude, Poland. The first 8 of 16 rows, exactly as Claude wrote them.

"LC Connect has 16 Polish leads linked to pulsed laser diodes. All have status NEW and none has an owner. [...] A product link in LC Connect means "sales fit", not confirmed use. [...] The city, product and confidence columns below come from my general knowledge and are unverified."

LEAD (LC CONNECT)	PLD FIT (LC CONNECT)	CITY (UNVERIFIED)	LIKELY PRODUCT / APPLICATION (UNVERIFIED)	CONFIDENCE OF ACTUAL PLD USE (UNVERIFIED)
Institut Optoelektroniki WAT	1550 nm	Warsaw	R&D on laser rangefinders, LiDAR, laser warning	High
WB Electronics (WB Group)	1550 nm	Ożarów Mazowiecki	Fire control, UAV and loitering munition sensors	Medium
Etronika	1550 nm	Warsaw area	Defence optoelectronics, observation devices	Medium
Mesko S.A.	905 nm	Skarżysko-Kamienna	Ammunition and missiles (proximity fuzes are the plausible fit)	Medium
WITU	905 nm	Zielonka	Weapons and ammunition test and R&D	Medium
Semicon Sp. z o.o.	905 nm	Komorów (near Warsaw)	Laser modules	Medium
Autocomp Management	905 nm	Szczecin	Simulators (fits only if they build laser engagement systems)	Low-medium
Huta Stalowa Wola (HSW)	1550 nm	Stalowa Wola	Vehicles and turrets; rangefinders more likely bought in as subsystems	Low-medium

Every name comes from our base. Where the base has no data, Claude says so instead of guessing silently.
source: raw/claude-with-Q1-v4.md (asked 22:17:59 CEST, after the fix)

Without LC Connect: Claude, Czech Republic. A plausible row that the assistant admits it cannot confirm.

COMPANY	CITY	PRODUCT / APPLICATION USING PLD	WAVELENGTH (LIKELY)	CONFIDENCE
Prototypa-ZM	Brno	Ammunition and fuze development; laser proximity fuzes would fit the portfolio, but I can't confirm they exist	905 nm typical for laser fuzes	Low
"Several entries (Prototypa, MESIT, Varroc, Camea) are inferences from what the company does, not known PLD designs."				

Sounds convincing, but none of these four is in our base, and the assistant itself calls them inferences. Each one has to be checked by hand.
source: raw/claude-without-Q2.md (asked 15:20 CEST)

How new leads get into the base: discovery, not just storage

The base is not a bought list. LC Connect has research tools that search the web for companies that fit a Laser Components product. The 396 companies in the base were found this way, country by country, then qualified and linked to a product. That is why a question like the one in this test is a quick filter, not a fresh web search, and why the answer comes back as records the team can work with.

STEP 1 Research Research tools scan the web for companies that fit a product: market analysis, application discovery, competitor analysis and lead enrichment.	STEP 2 Qualify Each candidate is linked to the LC product it fits, with sector, country, status and owner.	STEP 3 Work The team asks the assistant, assigns owners, adds notes and exports. Every change is logged.
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Web research runs through an external research service and needs its key configured. The web-research step was switched off during these tests; the service was configured and verified later the same night (2026-09-29, ~23:1x CEST), after every run in this comparison.

Why the base beats reading websites

- **It is the result of that discovery work, not the LC website.** 396 prospect companies in 34 countries, found and qualified for Laser Components products, each with sector, country, status and owner.
- **The assistant answers only from what is in the base** and says when something is missing.
- **Structured data means filter, count and compare in one question:** "Polish leads for PLDs, by status" instead of an afternoon of browsing.
- **Each user has their own account and role, and every change is logged.**
- **Results come as interactive tables and maps, with CSV export.**
- **This is the lead layer.** Connecting the ERP and contact history is the next step.

Five questions to try in the meeting

- 01

"Show Polish leads linked to pulsed laser diodes as a table with city, product, status and owner."

The question from this test, asked as a table.
- 02

"Which leads in Europe have no owner yet? Group them by sector."

Finds prospects nobody is working on.
- 03

"Give me lead analytics by sector and by country."

Where the base is strong, and where it is thin.
- 04

"Add a note to Etronika: 'call back after the trade fair'. Then show me all notes on that lead."

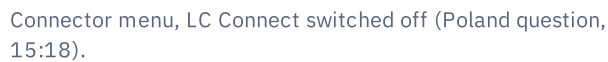
Writes to the base from the chat. The change is logged under your name.
- 05

"Which industries in Poland could use our 1550 nm pulsed laser diodes? Use discover_applications."

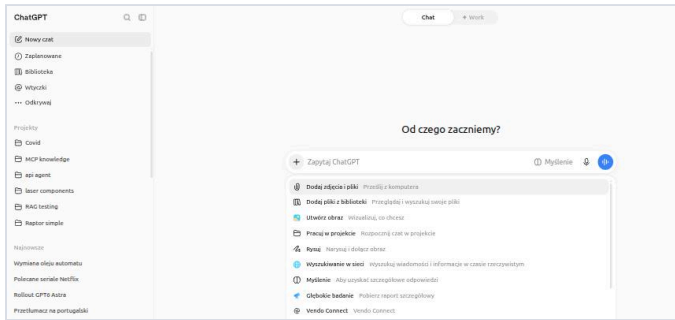
Discovery: finds new application areas and candidate companies.

REQUIRES RESEARCH SERVICE ENABLED

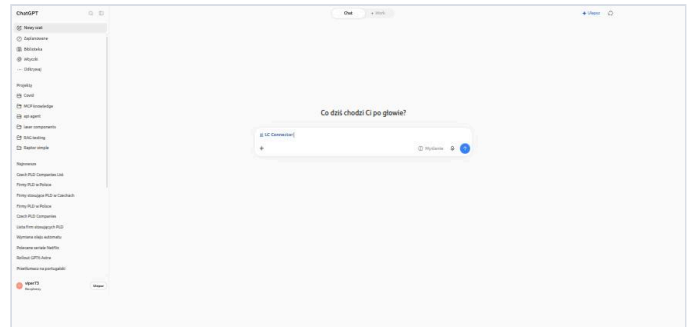
sources: LC-Connect-Comparison.md §2 (396 leads, fields) · raw/A_lc_leads_by_country.json (34 countries) · lc-connect-blueprint.html (roles, audit trail, widgets) · lc-connect/src/tools/ai.ts (analyze_product_market, discover_applications, analyze_competition, enrich_lead) · server log 2026-09-29 (enrich_lead: research key not set)



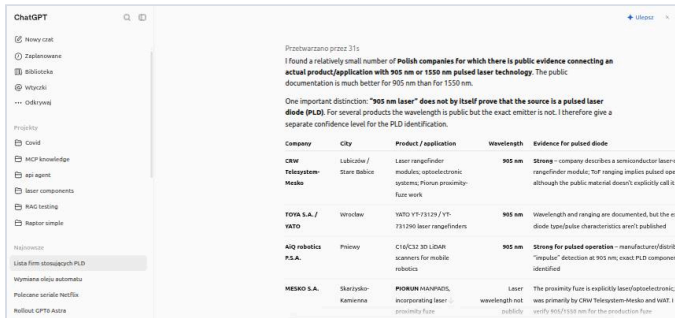
Screenshots: ChatGPT



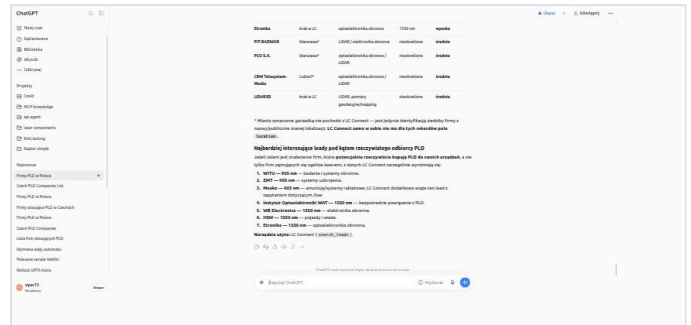
"+" menu, no app selected; LC Connect not yet installed (Poland question, 15:28).



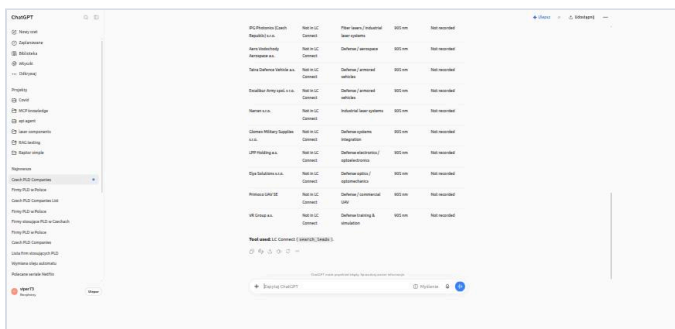
LC Connect selected for the chat (in ChatGPT it is named "LC Connector"), 22:43.



Answer without LC Connect: ChatGPT searched the web on its own.



Answer with LC Connect (in Polish): the last rows of 16 companies, all from our base; source named "LC Connect".



Czech Republic with LC Connect: 14 PLD prospects; city and confidence "not recorded" instead of guessed.

sources: raw/chatgpt-*.jpg (visible window only; full answer text in the matching raw/*.md)